

HISTORY HACK · DOCUMENT-BASED QUESTION

Document-Based Question

US.06 — Explain the characteristics and impact of the Granger movement and populism, emphasizing the conflicts between farmers and the railroads (i.e., credit mobilier and Interstate Commerce Act).

US.15 — Compare and contrast the ideas and philosophies of Booker T. Washington and W.E.B. Du Bois. (T.C.A. § 49-6-1006)

US.18 — Analyze the goals and achievements of the Progressive movement, including: • Adoption of the initiative, referendum, and recall • Adoption of the primary system • 16th Amendment • 17th Amendment

TEACHER EDITION — scoring guide and expected evidence. Not for student distribution.

Name _____ Class _____ Date _____

The sources

Document 1

Jacob Riis, *How the Other Half Lives: Studies Among the Tenements of New York*, Chapter I, 1890. Library of Congress digital collections.

“Long ago it was said that 'one half of the world does not know how the other half lives.' That was true then. It did not know because it did not care. The half that was on top cared little for the struggles, and less for the fate of those who were underneath, so long as it was able to hold them there and keep its own seat... The Problem of the Poor in New York is their own ignorance: ignorance of the possibilities of life in this land of freedom; ignorance of the right to demand better conditions; ignorance, in short, of the very existence of a problem.”

SOURCE IT — DOCUMENT 1

H — Historical context

What was happening when
this was made?

I — Intended audience

Who was meant to read or
hear it?

P — Purpose

What was it trying to make
the audience do or think?

P — Point of view

Who is speaking, and how
does that shape it?

Document 2

Jane Addams, *Twenty Years at Hull-House*, Chapter V, 1910. Library of Congress digital collections.

“Hull-House was soberly opened on the theory that the dependence of classes on each other is reciprocal; and that as the social relation is essentially a reciprocal relation, it gives a form of expression that has value for both sides. The residents of Hull-House were not going to that neighborhood to help people, but to try to understand them, and perchance to learn from them what could not be learned from books. The neighbors were quite as important an element of the settlement as its residents, and their lives were fully as significant as those of the educated visitors.”

SOURCE IT — DOCUMENT 2

H — Historical context

What was happening when
this was made?

I — Intended audience

Who was meant to read or
hear it?

P — Purpose

What was it trying to make
the audience do or think?

P — Point of view

Who is speaking, and how
does that shape it?

Document 3

Seventeenth Amendment to the United States Constitution, ratified April 8, 1913. National Archives, Washington, D.C.

“The Senate of the United States shall be composed of two Senators from each State, elected by the people thereof, for six years; and each Senator shall have one vote. The electors in each State shall have the qualifications requisite for electors of the most numerous branch of the State legislatures. When vacancies happen in the representation of any State in the Senate, the executive authority of such State shall issue writs of election to fill such vacancies.”

SOURCE IT — DOCUMENT 3

H — Historical context

What was happening when
this was made?

I — Intended audience

Who was meant to read or
hear it?

P — Purpose

What was it trying to make
the audience do or think?

P — Point of view

Who is speaking, and how
does that shape it?

The question

Remember to apply SOAPS to each document, construct a clear argument, use all three documents as evidence, and add at least two outside historical facts to your response.

Plan your answer

Your claim	
-------------------	--

Source	Evidence you will use	Why it supports your claim
Document 1		
Document 2		
Document 3		
Outside knowledge		

Write your response

Scoring guide

Pts	6-point scale
6	Exemplary. Constructs a clear, historically defensible argument responsive to the structural vs. symptomatic reform distinction in the prompt. Applies SOAPS to all three documents, with at least one SOAPS element per document used as direct argument evidence. Incorporates two or more outside historical facts. Demonstrates cross-document synthesis (e.g., comparing Riis's and Addams's reform philosophies, or connecting the 17th Amendment to political but not economic democracy). Addresses both structural conditions and their management. Response is organized with thesis, body paragraphs, and conclusion.
5	Advanced. Strong argument with SOAPS applied to all three documents. Two outside facts. Cross-document synthesis present. Minor gaps in analysis or organization.
4	Proficient. Clear argument with SOAPS applied to at least two documents. One outside fact. Structural vs. symptomatic distinction addressed but incompletely.
3	Adequate. Argument present but may focus on description over evaluation. SOAPS applied to one document. One outside fact or general knowledge applied.
2	Developing. Summarizes the documents without constructing an argument about effectiveness. No SOAPS or minimal application. No specific outside knowledge.
1	Beginning. Lists document information without argument or analysis.
0	No response or off-topic.

Expected evidence and document analysis. DOCUMENT ANALYSIS EXPECTATIONS (SOAPS): Doc 1 — Riis: Speaker's Danish immigrant background and photojournalism methods; nativist assumptions embedded in framing immigrant poverty as "ignorance"; the shock-journalism purpose and its effective mobilization of middle-class reform politics. Doc 2 — Addams: The reciprocity framework as a critique of top-down charity; the middle-class position of settlement house workers and its limits; Hull-House as a model for both service provision and social research. Doc 3 — 17th Amendment: The structural political reform targeting Senate corruption and machine politics; what direct election of senators addressed (political accountability) and did not address (economic power, wage levels, housing). KEY EVIDENCE EXPECTED: New York Tenement House Act (1901); Chinese Exclusion Act (1882) and Immigration Restriction League as nativist responses; Immigration Act of 1917 (literacy tests); immigration restriction act of 1924; Triangle Shirtwaist fire (1911) and subsequent NY labor laws; the 16th Amendment (income tax, 1913) as a more structural reform; machine politics and Tammany Hall's role in immigrant communities; AFL exclusion of unskilled, immigrant, and Black workers; Boss Tweed and the corruption that motivated the 17th Amendment.

Sourcing. Every document above carries its own citation as written in the item record. Verify each against the holding institution before classroom use — an unsourced primary source is worse than a missing one.

History Hack · TroopToTeacher Technologies. Tennessee Academic Standards 2027-28. classroom-formative · pre-field-test — this activity has not been field-tested and its scoring guide is not calibrated.